



DISPLAYS – PROFESSIONAL MONITORS

Not just for professionals, these beasts are good for multimedia too

When it comes to purchasing monitors for your PC, the two parameters that should matter to all of us are the quality of screen panel and display performance – especially since staring into monitor screens is what we all do the most. Last year, we witnessed the trend of curved displays well and truly taking off. This year we can honestly say that curved displays, while pretty and appealing to a niche, aren't really launching in big numbers. But 4K UHD monitors are a lot more prevalent in the market. Despite hints dropped at CES earlier this year, we haven't really seen any breakaway trend in terms of new display technology. OLED displays will have to wait for another year. With that, here are the best performing professional entertainment monitors (non-gaming) of the year, which are appealing to highly demanding!

ZERO 1 WINNER

ASUS ProArt PA328Q

There can be no doubt that hands down the ASUS PA328Q remains the best pro-series monitor we tested all year. It's a 32-inch, 4K UHD monitor sporting an impressive IPS panel reproducing very accurate colours viewable from highly acute angles without noticeable colour shift. The PA328Q muscled out the competition by sweeping through all three colour gamut tests – sRGB, AdobeRGB and NTSC. This shows the monitor has the widest colour range, better than any other display we tested all year. Its average brightness and maximum brightness was also better than any other monitors in the race. It not only aced six of our nine Spyder colorimeter reading tests, but also performed extremely well when it came to displaying still or moving visuals in a whole host of subjective tests we ran on the PA328Q. Not only is this the best professional grade monitor we tested this year, but also a great display for 4K UHD movies and video content.

SECOND

Benq BL2711U

This professional monitor's meant for designers, and while it falls short of the ASUS PA328Q by a whisker, make no mistakes it's one



ASUS ProArt PA328Q

Price: ₹1,00,000+



Benq BL2711U

Price: ₹61,990



Benq BL3201PT

Price: ₹1,00,000

of the best monitors we've tested all year. The BL2711U houses a 4K UHD display inside a 27-inch form factor, making it densely pixel-packed, reproducing crisp, sharp visuals that look great. In terms of our synthetic tests, the Benq BL2711U is second best to the ASUS ProArt PA328Q but better than other monitors in the fray. Definitely worth checking this out, if you're looking for a great performing 4K UHD monitor in a 27-inch form factor.

THIRD

Benq BL3201PT

The BL3201PT's predecessor, the BL3200PT, came second in our 2014 edition of Zero1 Awards. However, this 32-inch 4K UHD LED monitor impressed us with its overall brightness, contrast and colour gamut prowess. Its backlight bleed was also slightly less compared to other monitors in the fray. While the Benq BL2711U may be too small for some designer's tastes, the 32-inch BL3201PT offers the optimum size and fit and visual splendour for artists, professionals to work on and be inspired to do great work!

BEST BUY

Benq BL2711U

Not only does the Benq BL2711U sell for cheaper in comparison to the ASUS PA328Q and the Benq BL3201PT, but it offers near best in class performance – outperforming some of the more expensive professional monitors in the market – thereby offering great value for money. **4**